

Identification: This uses Loaded Language. Words like "dangerous," "radical," "bankrupt," and "destroy" are emotionally charged and biased, intended to provoke fear rather than present factual critique.

Task 2: Revise and Improve

Chosen Example (Loaded Language above):

My Revised Statement: "My opponent's proposed economic policy involves significant government spending, which some economists warn could lead to higher taxes or budget deficits that may impact middle-income households."

Task 3: Reflect

Avoiding fallacies is essential in academic writing because they undermine the logic and credibility of your argument. Fallacies like Hasty Generalization make your research seem careless, while Loaded Language reveals bias and weakens your ethos. Academic writing aims for objective, evidence-based persuasion. Using fallacies is the equivalent of building an argument on a weak foundation—it might look convincing at first glance, but it collapses under scrutiny. To be taken seriously as a scholar, I must build arguments that are not only passionate but also precise and logically sound.

Chapter 5: The Power of Sound Logic II & RADAR

第五章：逻辑的力量 II 与RADAR (Luójí de lìliàng II yǔ RADAR)

Your Goal for This Chapter 本章目标 (Běn zhāng mùbiāo): To master two more logical fallacies and learn the RADAR method for evaluating the credibility of your sources. A strong argument is built on sound logic *and* reliable evidence.

掌握另外两种逻辑谬误，并学习用于评估来源可信度的RADAR方法。一个强大的论证建立在可靠的逻辑和可靠的证据之上。

Lesson 5.1: Two More Tricks of the Trade

第一课：另外两个逻辑陷阱 (Lìngwài liǎng gè luójí xiànjǐng)

Activity:

Present students with two choices of home work. One has 2 questions, one had 10 questions. "Which one would you like?"

Part 1: Fallacy #3 - Either/Or (False Dilemma)

谬误 #3 - 非此即彼 (错误困境) (Fēi cǐ jí bǐ (Cuòwù kùnjìng))

What it is 是什么: Presenting only two possible options or outcomes when there are actually many more. It forces a black-and-white choice on a complex, grey issue.

当实际上存在更多可能性时，只呈现两种可能的选择或结果。它在一个复杂的、灰色的问题上强加了一个非黑即白的选择。

In simple terms 简单来说: "You're either with us, or against us." False simplicity.

"你要么与我们为伍，要么与我们为敌。"错误的简单化。

Everyday Example 日常例子:

- "You either support completely free speech for everyone, no matter what, or you're a supporter of censorship." - With us or against us statement - This is how wars start.
"你要么支持完全自由的言论，无论如何，要么你就是审查制度的支持者。"
- "We must either drastically cut taxes or our economy will collapse completely."
"我们要么大幅削减税收，要么我们的经济就会彻底崩溃。"

How to avoid it 如何避免: Acknowledge the complexity of issues. Use phrases like "we could consider," "another option might be," or "we must balance."

承认问题的复杂性。使用诸如“我们可以考虑”、“另一种选择可能是”或“我们必须平衡”之类的短语。

Part 2: Fallacy #4 - Slippery Slope

谬误 #4 - 滑坡谬误 (Huápō miùwù)

What it is 是什么: Arguing that a relatively small first step will inevitably lead to a chain of related (and terrible) events, without providing evidence for this chain reaction.

认为一个相对较小的第一步将不可避免地导致一系列相关的（且可怕的）事件，而没有为这种连锁反应提供证据。

In simple terms 简单来说: "If we let this happen, then that will happen, and then something terrible will happen!" A prediction of doom without proof. - Causal gap.

“如果我们让这件事发生，那么那件事就会发生，然后可怕的事情就会发生！”没有证据的厄运预测。

Everyday Example 日常例子:

- "If we allow students to use calculators in math class, they will forget how to do basic arithmetic. Then they won't be able to balance their checkbooks, and the entire financial system will collapse!"
“如果我们允许学生在数学课上使用计算器，他们就会忘记如何做基本算术。然后他们将无法平衡他们的支票簿，整个金融体系就会崩溃！”
- "If we pass this law to regulate one type of weapon, soon the government will take all our guns away, and we'll be unable to defend ourselves from tyranny."
“如果我们通过这项法律来管制一种武器，很快政府就会没收我们所有的枪支，我们将无法保卫自己免受暴政。”

How to avoid it 如何避免: Focus on the direct consequences of an action. Don't make extreme predictions about the far future without strong, logical evidence for each step in the chain.

关注一个行为的直接后果。如果没有强有力的、逻辑上的证据来证明链条中的每一步，就不要对遥远的未来做出极端预测。

Part 3: Practice: Spot the New Fallacies

练习：发现新的谬误 (Liànxí: Fāxiàn xīn de miùwù)

Instructions 说明: For each statement below, identify which fallacy is being used: **Either/Or (EO)** or **Slippery Slope (SS)**.

对于下面的每个陈述，识别所使用的谬误：**非此即彼 (EO)** 或 **滑坡谬误 (SS)**。

1. "If you don't get straight A's, you will never get into a good college or get a good job."
“如果你没有全科得A，你就永远进不了好大学，也找不到好工作。”
 - **Fallacy 谬误:** _____
2. "We can either invest all our money in renewable energy right now, or we can watch the planet become uninhabitable."
“我们要么现在就把所有的钱都投资于可再生能源，要么就眼睁睁地看着地球变得无法居住。”
 - **Fallacy 谬误:** _____
3. "If we start reading this one book that challenges our ideas, soon we won't believe in anything at all, and society will fall apart."
“如果我们开始阅读这本挑战我们想法的书，很快我们就会什么都不相信，社会就会分崩离析。”
 - **Fallacy 谬误:** _____
4. "You have a choice: agree with my plan entirely, or you are responsible for this project's failure."
“你有一个选择：完全同意我的计划，或者你对这个项目的失败负责。”
 - **Fallacy 谬误:** _____

Lesson 5.2: Your Source Evaluation Toolkit - RADAR

第二课：你的来源评估工具 - RADAR (Nǐ de láiyuán pínggū gōngjù - RADAR)

You've learned to make your own logic strong. Now, you must learn to check the logic and reliability of the sources you use for evidence.

你已经学会让自己的逻辑变得严密。现在，你必须学会检查你所使用的证据来源的逻辑性和可靠性。

Part 1: What is RADAR?

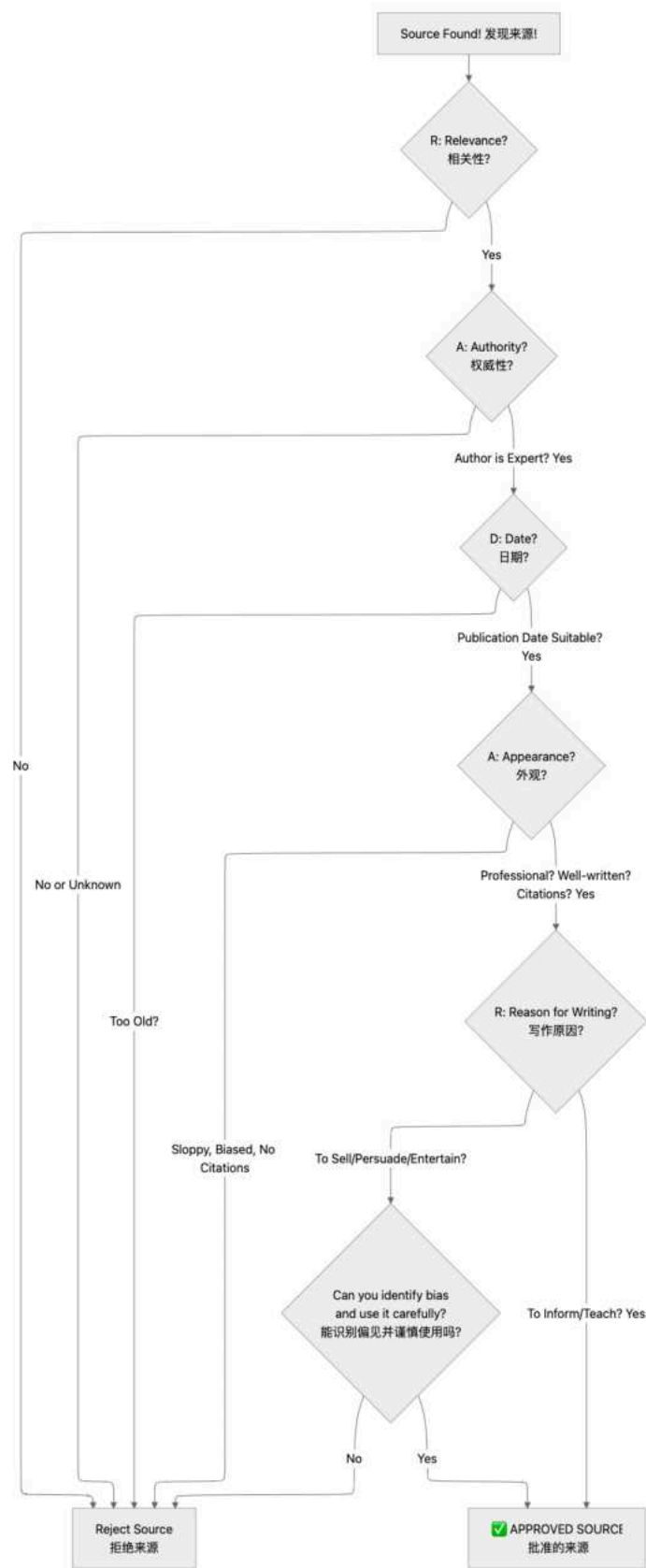
什么是RADAR ? (Shénme shì RADAR?)

RADAR is a set of criteria for deciding if a source (a website, article, book, video) is trustworthy and good enough to use in your academic work.

RADAR是一套标准，用于判断一个来源（网站、文章、书籍、视频）是否值得信赖且足够好，可以用于你的学术工作。

It stands for 它代表:

- **Relevance 相关性**
- **Authority 权威性**
- **Date 日期**
- **Appearance 外观**
- **Reason for writing 写作原因**



Part 2: Using the RADAR Checklist

使用RADAR检查清单 (Shǐyòng RADAR jiǎnchá qīngdān)

Let's break down what each letter means:

让我们分解每个字母的含义：

- **R - Relevance 相关性:**

How is this information related to my thesis? Who is the intended audience? Is it too simple or too advanced for my needs?

这些信息与我的论文有何关联？目标受众是谁？对我的需求来说是否太简单或太高级？

- **A - Authority 权威性:**

Who is the author/publisher? What are their credentials (education, experience)? Are they an expert in this field?

作者/出版商是谁？他们的 credentials（教育背景、经验）是什么？他们是这个领域的专家吗？

- **D - Date 日期:**

When was this published? Is the information current enough for my topic? For a science topic, you need very new sources. For a history topic, older sources might be okay.

这是什么时候发布的？这些信息对我的主题来说是否足够新？对于科学主题，你需要非常新的来源。对于历史主题，旧的来源可能也可以。

- **A - Appearance 外观:**

Does the source look professional? Is it well-written and free of errors? Does it cite its own sources? Does it have spelling mistakes or look sloppy?

这个来源看起来专业吗？它写得好好吗？没有错误吗？它引用它自己的来源了吗？有拼写错误或看起来马虎吗？

- **R - Reason for Writing 写作原因:**

Why was this source created? To inform, teach, sell, persuade, or entertain? Is it objective or biased?

这个来源为什么被创建？是为了告知、教导、销售、说服还是娱乐？它是客观的还是带有偏见的？

Lesson 5.3: Putting It All Together

第三课：综合应用 (Zònghé yìngyòng)

Part 1: Practice: Evaluate with RADAR

练习：用RADAR评估 (Liànxí: Yòng RADAR pínggū)

Instructions 说明: Imagine you are writing an essay on "The Effects of Social Media on Mental Health." You found the following source. Evaluate it using the RADAR criteria.

假设你正在写一篇关于“社交媒体对心理健康的影响”的文章。你找到了以下来源。使用RADAR标准评估它。

Source: A blog post titled "SOCIAL MEDIA IS A CANCER ON THE SOUL OF OUR YOUTH!" written by a famous lifestyle influencer on her personal website. It is full of strong opinions and emotional stories from her followers, but no links to scientific studies. It was published last month.

来源：一篇博文，标题为“社交媒体是我们青年灵魂的毒瘤！”，由一位著名生活方式影响者在她的个人网站上撰写。文章充满了强烈的观点和来自她粉丝的情感故事，但没有链接到科学研究。它于上个月发布。

- **Relevance 相关性:** Is it relevant to the topic? _____
 - **Notes 笔记:** _____
- **Authority 权威性:** Is the author an expert on mental health? _____
 - **Notes 笔记:** _____
- **Date 日期:** Is it current? _____
 - **Notes 笔记:** _____
- **Appearance 外观:** Does it look professional and well-researched? _____
 - **Notes 笔记:** _____

- **Reason 写作原因:** Why was it written? To inform, persuade, sell? _____
 - **Notes 笔记:** _____
 - **Verdict 最终判断:** Would this be a good, credible source for your academic essay? **YES / NO**
 - **Final Reasoning 最终理由:** _____
-

Homework: The Logical Detective

作业：逻辑侦探 (Luójí zhēntàn)

Task 1: Find the Fallacies 发现谬误

Find **one example** of **Either/Or** and **one example** of **Slippery Slope** in the real world (news, social media, conversation).
在现实世界（新闻、社交媒体、对话）中找到一个**非此即彼**的例子和一个**滑坡谬误**的例子。

- **Either/Or Example 非此即彼例子:** _____
 - **Slippery Slope Example 滑坡谬误例子:** _____
-

Task 2: Be a RADAR Analyst 成为一名RADAR分析师

Find **two** different sources online about a topic you are interested in. One should be credible, one should be unreliable.
在网上找到关于你感兴趣的主题的**两个**不同来源。一个应该是可信的，一个应该是不可靠的。

Apply the RADAR checklist to both. Write a short paragraph explaining which source is better for academic use and why.
对两者应用RADAR检查清单。写一段短文，解释哪个来源更适合学术用途以及原因。

- **Source 1 (Good or Bad?):** _____
 - **RADAR Analysis RADAR分析:** _____
 - **Source 2 (Good or Bad?):** _____
 - **RADAR Analysis RADAR分析:** _____
 - **Which is better? 哪个更好?** _____
 - **Why? 为什么?** _____
-

Task 3: Reflect 反思

Why is it just as important to evaluate your sources as it is to make your own logic strong?
为什么评估你的来源和你让自己的逻辑变得严密一样重要？

Example Homework: The Logical Analyst – Grading Rubric & Example

This assignment is a **Coursework Assessment**. It will be graded on a scale of 0–10 points.

Grading Rubric

Criteria	Excellent (9–10 pts)	Good (7–8 pts)	Satisfactory (5–6 pts)	Needs Improvement (0–4 pts)
Task 1: Find the Fallacies	Both examples are clear, real-world instances of Either/Or and Slippery Slope fallacies. Identification is correct and includes a brief explanation.	Examples are relevant and correctly identified. Explanation is present.	One example may be weak or incorrectly identified. Explanation is vague.	Examples are missing or incorrectly identified.
Task 2: Be a RADAR Analyst	Both sources are clearly credible or unreliable. The RADAR analysis is thorough for all five criteria. The paragraph convincingly explains which source is better and why, using specific RADAR points.	Both sources are analysed with RADAR. The paragraph correctly identifies the better source with logical reasoning.	RADAR analysis is incomplete or superficial for one or both sources. The comparison paragraph is vague or lacks justification.	RADAR analysis is missing or incorrect. The comparison is absent or illogical.
Task 3: Reflect	Reflection thoughtfully connects the skills of spotting fallacies and evaluating sources, explaining how they work together to build rigorous academic thinking.	Reflection adequately explains the importance of both skills for research and argumentation.	Reflection is brief and lacks connection between the two skills.	Reflection is missing or off-topic.

Example of a Completed Homework Assignment

Task 1: Find the Fallacies

Either/Or Example:

From a debate on education: "We either completely ban smartphones in schools, or we accept that students will never learn to focus again."

Identification: This is an Either/Or (False Dilemma) fallacy. It presents only two extreme options, ignoring middle-ground solutions like regulated use or tech-integrated lessons.

Slippery Slope Example:

From an online forum: "If we allow this one history book to be revised, next they'll rewrite all of history, and soon our children won't know any facts at all!"

Identification: This is a Slippery Slope fallacy. It predicts an inevitable chain of extreme events from a single action without evidence for each step.

Task 2: Be a RADAR Analyst

Source 1 (Credible): Article from *Journal of Adolescent Health* titled "Longitudinal Effects of Social Media Use on Teen Well-Being" (2023).

RADAR Analysis:

- **Relevance:** Directly addresses mental health and social media.
- **Authority:** Published in a peer-reviewed journal; authors are PhDs in psychology.
- **Date:** 2023 – very current.
- **Appearance:** Professional layout, academic language, full citations.
- **Reason:** To inform and present research findings. **Verdict:** Excellent source.

Source 2 (Unreliable): Blog post "Why Social Media is Satan's Tool" on a personal conspiracy theory website (2024).

RADAR Analysis:

- **Relevance:** Talks about social media but from a religious/biased angle.
- **Authority:** Anonymous author, no credentials.